

Jothi Tutor Development Standards

TUTOR CERTIFICATION AND SIGN-OFF STANDARD

The formal process for confirming tutor readiness for independent teaching

Author	Prakash Micheal — Johti Learning, United Kingdom
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Intended Audience	Mentors, mentor panel, and academy leadership
Related Documents	JTD01 v2.0, JTD02 v2.0, JTD03 v2.0, JTD04 v2.0, JTD05

1. Purpose

This document defines the certification and sign-off process for the Johti Tutor Academy. It covers three things only: the criteria a tutor must meet, the decision-making process, and the recording requirements. Everything else — how tutors develop toward readiness — is in JTD03 v2.0.

Certification is a formal quality decision. It confirms that a tutor can teach independently at the required Johti standard with sufficient clarity, consistency, and professional reliability. It is not a reward for completing the residency. It is not automatic. It requires a deliberate panel decision backed by credible evidence.

2. Sign-Off and Certification — The Difference

These two terms are related but not the same. Conflating them weakens both.

	Sign-Off	Certification
What it is	Recognition that a tutor has demonstrated a specific competency to the required standard in live teaching.	Formal confirmation that the tutor is ready to teach independently at the full Johti standard.
Who decides	The observing mentor, supported by evidence from the JTD04 observation record.	The mentor panel collectively, after reviewing the full Final Readiness Pack.
When it happens	Throughout the residency — as evidence accumulates in each stage.	Once, at the end of the Certification Runway, after all threshold evidence is in place.
What it requires	Repeated, credible, observable evidence of a named competency. Not a single strong moment.	Evidence meeting all three JCT thresholds (see Section 4). Panel confidence in sustained readiness.

	Sign-Off	Certification
What it is not	A tick-box after a good lesson. A mentor's general positive impression. Self-reported confidence.	An automatic outcome of completing the residency stages. A reward for time served.

3. Competency Sign-Off Process

Sign-off happens within the normal observation cycle. It is not a separate event or a special lesson. When a mentor observes teaching that demonstrates a competency to the required standard — repeatedly and credibly — they record the sign-off in the JTD04 form and update the JTD05 dashboard.

Sign-Off Criteria

- The relevant competency was clearly visible in live teaching — not inferred from general performance.
- The evidence is specific. The JTD04 record names the competency, describes what was observed, and references a lesson moment or timestamp where possible.
- The quality of demonstration is credible — not a one-off moment under ideal conditions, but a teaching behaviour that is becoming consistent.
- The sign-off is for the competency code stated. Mentors do not sign off one competency as evidence for a different one.

Sign-Off Is Not Final Until Dashboard Is Updated

A sign-off recorded only on a paper form or in a mentor's memory does not exist in the JTA system. Every sign-off must be reflected in the JTD05 dashboard. The dashboard is the evidence record that the mentor panel reviews. If it is not there, it does not count.

Who Can Sign Off

Competency Level	Who Can Sign Off
JCT1 — Core	Any assigned mentor who has directly observed the teaching. Must have completed a JTD04 form for the relevant lesson.
JCT2 — Developing	Any assigned mentor with direct observation evidence. JCT2 sign-offs should be confirmed against at least two observation records before being logged.
JCT3 — Advanced	Requires mentor panel confirmation. A single mentor's sign-off on a JCT3 competency must be ratified by the panel before it is accepted as final.

4. Certification Criteria

Before the mentor panel can certify a tutor, all three conditions below must be met. These are minimum thresholds, not the full picture. The panel must also be satisfied that the evidence pattern is credible and that the tutor's readiness is sustainable — not a recent peak.

Level	Competencies	Threshold	Cannot Be Waived
JCT1 — Core	C1, C2, C3, A4, F2, F3, F4	All 7 must be signed off and showing consistent evidence.	Yes. No certification if any JCT1 competency is unsigned.
JCT2 — Developing	A1, A2, B1, B2, C4, C5, D1, E1, E2, F1	Minimum 8 of 10 must be signed off.	The 2 unsigned must be formally noted and reviewed by the panel.
JCT3 — Advanced	A3, B3, D2, D3, D4	Minimum 3 of 5 must be signed off.	The unsigned competencies become post-certification development targets.

Meeting these thresholds is necessary but not sufficient. The panel reviews the quality and pattern of evidence, not just the count. A dashboard showing 22 sign-offs built from weak or poorly evidenced observations does not support certification.

5. The Final Readiness Pack

Before the certification panel convenes, the Final Readiness Pack must be assembled. This is the evidence bundle the panel reviews. It must be complete before the panel meeting — not during it.

Required Contents

Document	Requirement
JTD05 Dashboard	Up to date. All sign-offs logged. Competency coverage visible by level. No outstanding updates.
JTD04 Mentor Observation Records	All records from Co-Teaching, Lead Teaching, and Independent Teaching stages. Minimum 8 observations across the residency (2 Co-Teaching, 4 Lead Teaching, minimum 2 Independent Teaching with 1 calibration).
JTD02 Tutor Reflection Records	All reflections from the 6-week Independent Teaching cycle. Minimum 6 records. Earlier reflections are optional but useful context.
Second-Mentor Calibration Record	At least 1 calibration observation from a mentor who is not the primary mentor. Completed during Independent Teaching.
Assessment and Progress Evidence	Evidence relevant to D1, D2, D3, D4. May include test results, progress tracking records, and the tutor's documented response to assessment outcomes.
Parent Communication Sample	Required for F1 sign-off. At least one evidence sample of written parent communication reviewed by the mentor.
Final Evidence Plan	The agreed plan from the start of the Certification Runway, showing which gaps were identified and what actions were taken to address them.

Pack Completeness Check

The primary mentor confirms the pack is complete before submitting it to the panel. An incomplete pack delays the panel meeting — it does not justify proceeding without the missing evidence.

6. Certification Decision Process

Step	Action	Detail
1	Pack submitted	Primary mentor confirms the Final Readiness Pack is complete and submits it to all panel members at least 48 hours before the panel meeting.
2	Panel review	Each panel member reviews the pack independently before the meeting. The meeting is for discussion and decision — not for reading documents for the first time.
3	Panel discussion	Panel discusses: Is the evidence consistent and credible? Are the JCT thresholds genuinely met? Are there any concerns that outweigh the evidence? Is there anything in the pattern that suggests the tutor is not ready?
4	Decision	Panel reaches a decision from the four possible outcomes (see Section 7). The decision is collective. If panel members disagree, the decision is deferred until consensus or a structured review process is agreed.
5	Communication	The tutor is told the outcome directly — the decision, the reasons, any development targets, and what happens next. No ambiguity. No delay.
6	Recording	The outcome is recorded in the academy's tutor records within 5 working days of the panel decision. The JTD05 dashboard is updated to reflect the certification status.

7. Possible Outcomes

Outcome	Meaning	What Happens Next
Certified	All JCT thresholds met. Evidence is credible and consistent. Panel has full confidence in the tutor's readiness for independent teaching.	Tutor is formally certified. Certification date and panel decision are recorded. Any JCT3 competencies not yet signed off become the first post-certification development targets.
Certified with Development Targets	JCT thresholds met. Certification is confirmed. Specific areas remain weaker and are named as ongoing development priorities.	Tutor is certified and begins independent teaching. Named development targets are reviewed in the first post-certification mentor check-in.
Extended Runway	JCT thresholds not yet fully met. Specific gaps are	Panel agrees a specific set of additional actions with a clear timeline. A second

Outcome	Meaning	What Happens Next
	identifiable and addressable. The tutor is close to ready but not there yet.	panel review is scheduled. The tutor is told exactly what is needed.
Not Yet Certified	Evidence is insufficient or unconvincing. The tutor is not yet ready for independent teaching.	Panel explains the decision directly and in full. A structured development plan is agreed. No ambiguity about what is required. A clear timeline for reassessment is set.

Deferred certification is not a failure of the residency. It is the system working correctly. The purpose of the certification standard is to protect teaching quality. Premature certification harms students and undermines the academy's credibility.

8. Post-Certification Expectations

Certification marks the start of independent teaching responsibility — not the end of professional development. Certified tutors are expected to:

- Maintain all JCT1 and JCT2 competency standards in live teaching.
- Continue working toward any unsigned JCT3 competencies identified at certification.
- Complete the Ayotree attendance record accurately after every lesson.
- Engage with periodic mentor review where the academy requires it.
- Escalate concerns — safeguarding, student welfare, or operational — through the correct channels without delay.

Certification can be reviewed if there is sustained evidence of performance falling below the required standard. The mentor panel retains the authority to initiate a formal review at any point.

9. Recording Requirements

Every sign-off and certification decision must be formally recorded. Undocumented decisions do not exist in the JTA system. The following records are required.

Record Type	Where Recorded	Required Fields
Competency Sign-Off	JTD05 Dashboard + JTD04 Form	Tutor name, competency code, date, observing mentor, evidence note or timestamp link.
Certification Decision	Academy Tutor Records + JTD05	Tutor name, certification date, panel members, outcome, any development targets, summary note.
Extended Runway or Deferral	Academy Tutor Records	Tutor name, decision date, reason for deferral, specific required actions, timeline, next review date.
Post-Certification Development Targets	JTD05 + Tutor Record	Competency codes targeted, agreed timeline, responsible mentor, review date.

10. Mentor Panel Conduct

The mentor panel makes the most consequential decisions in the academy. Panel members are expected to hold the following standards.

Standard	What It Requires
Evidence-first decisions	Panel decisions are based on the evidence in the pack — not on personal rapport with the tutor, the primary mentor's confidence, or operational need.
No conflicts of interest	A mentor who has a personal relationship with the tutor being reviewed should declare it. The panel lead decides whether that mentor votes or abstains on the final decision.
Preparation before the meeting	Every panel member reads the full Readiness Pack before the meeting. Arriving unprepared and deciding on the spot weakens the decision.
Candid discussion	Panel members say what they actually think. Agreeing with the primary mentor to avoid conflict, or deferring because someone else seems more certain, produces bad decisions.
Proportionate firmness	Do not certify to solve a staffing problem. Do not defer when the evidence is genuinely sufficient. Both errors damage the academy.

11. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
All residency pathway content removed	JTD06 v1.0 restated residency logic that belongs in JTD03. v2.0 is a decision document only. JTD03 v2.0 owns the pathway.
Sign-off and certification distinction formalised	v1.0 blurred the two. v2.0 defines them clearly and separately, with different decision-makers, criteria, and recording requirements.
JCT certification thresholds made explicit	v1.0 stated that evidence was required without specifying how much. v2.0 gives numerical thresholds per level, aligned with JTD01 v2.0.
Four decision outcomes defined	v1.0 described possible deferral without naming the full range of outcomes. v2.0 defines all four outcomes with specific follow-on actions for each.
Final Readiness Pack contents specified	v1.0 referred to 'evidence' without specifying what documents were required. v2.0 lists every required document and its minimum standard.
Panel conduct section added	New in v2.0. The panel is the most important quality mechanism in the academy. Its conduct standards needed to be explicit.

Jothi Learning — United Kingdom

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